



When Odin found out about the Mead of Poetry he decided to claim it for the Aesir. He travelled in disguise to a farm owned by Suttung's brother, Baugi, and found nine of his servants harvesting wheat. Sensing an opportunity, Odin offered to sharpen their scythes with his whetstone.

The whetstone proved so effective that the servants wanted to buy it. But instead, Odin threw it into the air. "First one to grab it, keeps it!" he cried. The servants leaped all at once and in the confusion died on the blades of their own scythes.

"Now for the next part of my plan," thought Odin, stepping over their tangled bodies. He went to Baugi and said, "I'm afraid all your servants have died in a terrible accident."



*"But I'll do their work," continued Odin. "In return for a sip of the Mead of Poetry."*

Baugi agreed. And so Odin toiled and finished the harvest. Together, Odin and Baugi visited Suttung. But Suttung refused to give Odin his due. Odin now turned to Baugi, "You still owe me, my friend. I hope you prove more honourable than your brother." Sensing threat in Odin's words, Baugi took a drill and bored a hole in the mountain, all the way to the chamber where Suttung had hidden the mead.

